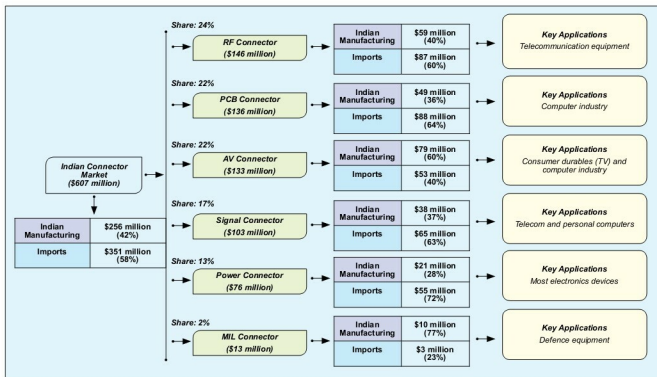




Types of connectors and their market share (source: ELCOMOS report by ELCINA)

Types and applications

Connectors are classified based on their shape or by the application. Manufacturers in India classify connectors based on their application. These are broadly classified into six types: radio-frequency (RF) connectors (\$146 million), PCB connectors (\$136 million), audio-video (AV) connectors (\$133 million), signal connectors (\$103 million), power connectors (\$76 million) and MIL connectors (\$13 million).

The demand for RF connectors is expected to grow faster than the other types of connectors. The growth in RF connector segment is expected to be driven by the growth in telecom segment. The government is planning to install an additional 11,000 towers in 500 districts in rural areas to provide

network for mobile and landline.

The growth in PCB connectors and signal connectors is expected due to the growth in computer industry. Transportation (railways) is another sector that is a major user of PCB connectors and signal connectors.

"Modern trains carry much more complex electrical networks today than a few years ago. At the same time, our signaling system must become even more intelligent to manage the ever-increasing rail traffic. All this needs a lot of modularity and plug-and-play systems, which is fuelling the demand for connectors that carry power, signal and data. Various connectors like high-speed PCB connectors, DIN connectors, M12 connectors and D-Subs are the typical connectors used in rail

application today," informs Girish Rao, CEO at HARTING India.

Consumer electronics market is one of the largest segments in the Indian electronics industry. This, in turn, is expected to drive the AV connector growth.

With spends in defence expected to increase significantly over the next few years, the demand for MIL connectors is also slated to witness a growth. However, the requirement of highly-skilled labour and high-precision equipment makes manufacturing of such components unviable in India currently.

India continues to be a large consumer of electronics products and the rate of growth of adoption has increased over the last few years. With the reduction in the cost of LCD TVs, thus making these affordable to the masses, the overall TV segment is poised for the next big growth. A similar growth opportunity is exhibited by the mobile handset market too. With companies like Nokia and Samsung setting up their assembly or production plants in India, the country could

"The latest development is easy cage clamp/crimp type connections. These connections have a really good impact on design in railway segment because they are free from human error" —Nirmal Kumar Saraf, head-accessories, Lapp India

